they do and making them all work together seamlessly. Without the Rails component, not much would happen. But at the same time, only a small part of this underlying infrastructure is relevant to developers in their day-to-day work. We'll cover the parts that *are* relevant in the rest of this chapter.

Let's start with the text files in the top of the application directory:

- `config.ru` configures the Rack Webserver Interface, either to create Rails Metal applications or to use Rack Middlewares in your Rails application. These are discussed further in the Rails Guides.[95]

- `Gemfile` specifies the dependencies of your Rails application. You've already seen this in use when the `bcrypt-ruby` gem was added to the Depot application. Application dependencies also include the database, web server, and even scripts used for deployment.

  Technically, this file isn't used by Rails but rather by your application. You can find calls to the Bundler[96] in the `config/application.rb` and `config/boot.rb` files.

- `Gemfile.lock` records the specific versions for each of your Rails application's dependencies. This file is maintained by Bundler and should be checked into your repository.

- `Rakefile` defines tasks to run tests, create documentation, extract the current structure of your schema, and more. Type `rake -T` at a prompt for the full list. Type `rake -D task` to see a more complete description of a specific task.

- `README` contains general information about the Rails framework.

Let's look at what goes into each directory (although not necessarily in order).

A Place for Our Application

Most of our work takes place in the `app` directory. The main code for the application lives below the `app` directory, as shown in the figure. We'll talk more about the structure of the `app` directory as we look at the various Rails modules